LESSON 7

Guidelines for Writing Your CV

It can take a reader just 30 seconds to reach a decision about a CV. So when writing a CV, you should remember you have just half a minute to gain the reader's interest, leave a clear impression of professionalism and indicate the likely benefit to an employer of hiring you. To prepare a CV which is effective will take time and possibly several drafts. Layout, presentation and a choice of words which demonstrate both responsibility and achievement are vital components of any CV.

No matter how well your career background and skills match the needs of an employer, your efforts could fail if you make it difficult for the reader to take in the relevant information. As your message must register quickly, make the reader's task an easy one. Ensure that the print is well spaced and that the key information is displayed clearly.

The purpose of the CV is to generate interviews. Visually, you want your CV to have a positive effect, but it is also necessary for it to convince the reader that you are worth meeting. The style in which you present your CV is a matter of personal choice, but it is important that you use words which suggest an active and successful career.

People sometimes make the mistake of regarding a CV as a rewrite of their job description, which results in unnecessary jargon and detail. In addition, issues such as salary and reasons for leaving previous employers should not be included; they are best discussed at the first interview stage.

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